

Module 3: Classification

Introduction

Definition

- Predict discrete value or class
- Categorization of objects

Classification vs Regression

- Classification: Discrete/Categorical
- Regression: Continuous/Numeric

Types of Classification

By Number of Classes

- Binary: Two possible values (e.g., Yes/No)
- Multiclass: More than two values (e.g., Crop types)

By Approach

- Posteriori: Supervised (Labeled data)
- Priori: Unsupervised (Unlabeled data/Clustering)

Working Process

- Step 1: Training (Building the classifier)
- Step 2: Testing (Accuracy assessment)

Attributes

- Input: Independent attributes
- Output: Dependent/Class attribute

Decision Tree Classifier

Terminologies

- Root Node: Entire dataset/Start
- Leaf Node: Final output/Outcome
- Splitting: Dividing nodes
- Pruning: Removing unwanted branches

Attribute Selection Measures (ASM)

- Information Gain
- Entropy (Impurity/Randomness)
- Gini Index (Used in CART)

Pros and Cons

- Advantages: Visual, Handles Non-linear, Fast
- Disadvantages: Overfitting, Instability

Rule Based Classifier

- Structure: If-Then rules
- Components: Antecedent (Precondition) and Consequent

Properties

- Coverage
- Accuracy
- Mutually Exclusive vs Exhaustive

Naïve Bayes Method

- Based on Bayes Theorem
- Calculates Conditional Probability
- Feature Independence Assumption

Applications

- Spam Filtering
- Sentiment Analysis
- Medical Diagnosis

Performance Metrics

- Confusion Matrix
- Accuracy: $(TP+TN)/Total$
- Precision: $TP/(TP+FP)$
- Recall: $TP/(TP+FN)$
- F-measure: Harmonic mean of Precision and Recall